smaller agency.

Fixing the entry point for Beverage Alcohol Brands.

A diagnostic for beverage alcohol brands missing Gen Z.

How to use.

SCORE EACH LINE FROM 1 TO 5

1	2	3	4	5
STRONGLY DISAGREE	DISAGREE	NEUTRAL	AGREE	STRONGLY AGREE

BE HONEST.

This is where brands usually lie to themselves.

smaller

1. Instant Shelf Legibility

A first time buyer can understand what this is in under 3 seconds.

1 2 3 4 5

2. Zero Homework Required

The brand works without knowing regions, processes, hierarchies, or rules.

1 2 3 4 5

3. Visual Before Verbal

The packaging still makes sense if all copy is removed.

1 2 3 4 5

4. Permission to Participate

The brand feels welcoming, not intimidating or judgmental.

1 2 3 4 5

5. Social Usability

It feels easy to order, share, bring to a party, and post on camera.

1 2 3 4 5

6. Identity First

The brand clearly communicates who it's for before how it's made.

1 2 3 4 5

7. Entry SKU Strength

Your entry SKU is the most inviting version of the brand, not the cheapest.

1 2 3 4 5

8. Heritage Placement

Heritage supports the story but does not lead it.

1 2 3 4 5

9. First Choice Intent

This brand was intentionally designed to be a first alcohol choice.

1 2 3 4 5

10. Honest Launch Test

If this launched today, a 23-year-old would choose it without explanation.

1 2 3 4 5

smaller

Gen Z Risk Rating Score.

ADD UP YOUR TOTAL OUT OF 50.

40 TO 50 — LOW RISK
You are built for Gen Z entry.
Your challenge is scale, not relevance.

30 TO 39 — MODERATE RISK
You are partially legible but still rely on inherited trust.
Entry is fragile.

20 TO 29 — HIGH RISK
Gen Z does not reject you.
They simply never choose you first.

BELOW 20 — CRITICAL RISK
Your brand assumes literacy instead of earning it.
You are aging out by design.